

JOSEPH CUFFNEY

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Professional Summary

Staff software engineer and builder with 10+ years across industry and personal ventures — shipping production platforms at Coinbase and Nike, and Rust firmware, custom PCBs, and agentic AI systems as a maker. I bring software rigor to the physical world.

Experience

🕒 Coinbase · Staff Software Engineer

January 2026 – Present · Remote

Capital Formation

- Led a 10-engineer team to launch a new capital formation platform supporting IPOs alongside token sales.
- Set technical direction and went to production in 2 months, raising over \$250M for the first issuer.

🕒 Coinbase · Senior Software Engineer

January 2022 – January 2026 · Remote

GraphQL Federation

- Designed a federated GraphQL architecture replacing the GraphQL monolith and set technical direction for migrating teams — reducing build times and improving performance and reliability.
- Led the first subgraph (Golang, gqlgen), mentoring engineers across teams as they built their own.

INTX Exchange

- Planned, built, and launched perpetual futures — a net-new asset type for retail advanced trading.
- Owned monitoring, reliability, and incident response for the global rollout — \$1B+ traded in year one.

🏢 Nike Valiant Labs · Sr. Software Engineer III

June 2018 – December 2021 · Portland, OR / Remote

Cultivator

- Built an early iteration of what became Nike By You — a creator-driven sneaker-design marketplace where, across multiple campaigns, 100+ creators sold 500k+ pairs of shoes benefiting charities of their choice.
- Designed the microservice architecture — API Gateway fronting Lambda and ECS — plus CI/CD pipelines.

🏢 Nike Valiant Labs · Lead Software Engineer (contract)

August 2017 – June 2018 · Portland, OR

Tandem Personal Training

- Built a subscription service connecting clients with personal trainers — Craft CMS on Elastic Beanstalk, AWS Lambda, and a two-party Stripe payment system (invoicing, transfers, refunds, automated renewals).
- Led sprint planning, backlog grooming, and estimation for the team.

🏢 The Program · Technical Lead

October 2015 – August 2017 · Portland, OR

- Took technical ownership of agency projects across React/Redux, Express, Spring Boot, and Craft.
- Owned developer operations — environments and CI — using Jenkins, Ansible, Docker, and DigitalOcean.

Education

Rochester Institute of Technology · Rochester, NY
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

Skills

AI & AGENTIC

Claude & OpenAI APIs Claude Agent SDK MCP Multi-agent orchestration
Local LLMs (Ollama, llama.cpp) LLM tuning

LANGUAGES

Rust C/C++ TypeScript JavaScript Go Python

FRAMEWORKS

React React Native Dioxus Embassy Tonic

API DESIGN

GraphQL (Federation) gRPC REST

TOOLS

Claude n8n Docker Kubernetes Datadog Snowflake Autodesk Fusion KiCad

INFRA

AWS Terraform CloudFormation Proxmox

EMBEDDED

Arduino ESP32 PCB Design

PROTOCOLS

I2C SPI UART BLE MQTT

Projects

🦋 Orca(stration) AI · From The Forest

- Building a platform that makes AI agents first-class members of the org chart — all-Rust microservices on Kubernetes, with LDAP extended so humans and agents coexist in the same directory tooling.
- Designed an agentic reasoning loop — autonomous within guardrails, escalating to a human beyond them.
- Built an AI budgeting system on micropayments (x402), keeping agent spend within budget and ROI measurable.

🦋 Local Agentic AI & RAG Consulting · From The Forest

- Implemented local-first RAG and memory systems on SurrealDB and Postgres, keeping client data on-prem.
- Built n8n automations around those systems, saving clients 20+ hours of manual work per week.

📱 On Set! · Set-location discovery app

- Co-founded a set-location discovery app that mapped 2,000+ film set locations and built relationships with 200 small businesses; reached 1,000 monthly active users in the first year.
- Designed and built the website and React Native app, with a GraphQL microservice API (Apollo Federation) on AWS Lambda, DynamoDB, and Elasticsearch — plus a landing page and digital marketing.

🏠 ESP32 Aquaponics System

- Built an aquaponics system to grow greens at home year round — ESP32 firmware in Rust on Embassy.
- Automated flood-and-drain cycles with pumps and valves driven by temperature, humidity, and moisture sensors.
- Designed a custom PCB to replace the breadboard prototype — schematic capture through fabrication.

🏠 ESP32 Wildlife Camera

- Built an ESP32 camera with firmware in Rust that captures wildlife activity in the creek by the house.
- Ships images over WiFi to the homelab, where local inference identifies the species.

🏠 Homelab

- Run a Proxmox cluster self-hosting services and local LLM inference (Ollama, llama.cpp).
- Serves as the local inference backend for the wildlife camera's species identification.